



Grade 6 FAST ELA Reading

Spring 2024 Released Test Items

Passage 1:

Mary Anderson: Windshield Wipers

by Catherine Thimmesh

- 1 It was a dreadful day, weatherwise. Snow and sleet pelted the pavement, and people burrowed deep within their coats. Hoping to catch the sights and escape the blustery cold, Mary Anderson of Birmingham, Alabama, climbed aboard a New York City streetcar. The year was 1902. It turned out to be a ride she would never forget, but not because of the scenery. Instead, the ride would inspire her to invent the very first windshield wiper. And simply because she felt sorry for the streetcar driver, who struggled to see through the glass. The invention would not only improve conditions for all drivers, but would save countless lives as well.
- 2 Earlier, top-notch engineers had tackled the problem of poor visibility in bad weather and came up with a solution. They split the windshield. Once the glass became covered with rain or snow, the streetcar driver could fling open the middle for a clear view. Trouble was, it didn't work. At least not very well. Mary watched helplessly as the driver desperately tried to see. When he opened the split glass, he was greeted with a burst of icy cold air and a blast of heavy, wet snow.
- 3 *"Why doesn't someone create a device to remove the snow?" Mary reportedly asked the people around her.*
- 4 *"It's been tried many times," they told her. "Can't be done."*
- 5 Nonsense, thought Mary, as she scribbled in her notebook. Why can't there be a lever on the inside that would move an arm on the outside to swipe off the snow? . . .
- 6 Later, when she returned to her home in Birmingham, she studied her sketches. She spent some time refining her drawings—making them more elaborate, adding more details. Satisfied at last, she brought her design to a small manufacturing company in Birmingham and hired them to make a model. Then, she filed a patent application.
- 7 *"My invention relates to an improvement in window-cleaning devices in which a radially-swinging arm is actuated by a handle from inside of a car-vestibule," Mary stated in her patent specification.*
- 8 In other words, a lever on the inside that would move an arm on the outside. Mary's wiper was made of wooden strips and pieces of rubber. She designed it to be removed in good weather so that it would not interfere with the appearance of the streetcar. One of her most important elements was the addition of a counterweight.

- 9 *This was used, she writes, “to provide means for maintaining a uniform pressure upon the glass throughout the entire area swept by my improved window-cleaning device.”*
- 10 In other words, it would swipe off the snow. Mary was awarded a patent in 1903 for a window-cleaning device—a windshield wiper. Once the invention was protected by patent, she wrote a large Canadian company offering to sell her rights. They weren’t interested. After reviewing her proposal, they decided that her invention had little, if any, commercial value. They simply didn’t think it would sell. They encouraged her, however, to submit any other “useful patents” she might have for their consideration.
- 11 Mary put the patent in a drawer and, eventually, it expired. Several years later, someone else revived her idea, patented it, sold it, and made a very large sum of money. Every day, lives are saved due to increased visibility during bad weather. Even in our high-tech society, the windshield wiper remains one of the greatest safety inventions of the modern-day automobile.

Figure 1.

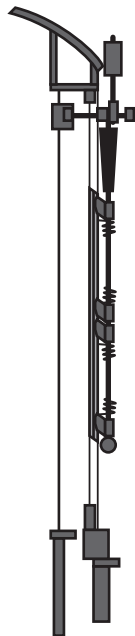
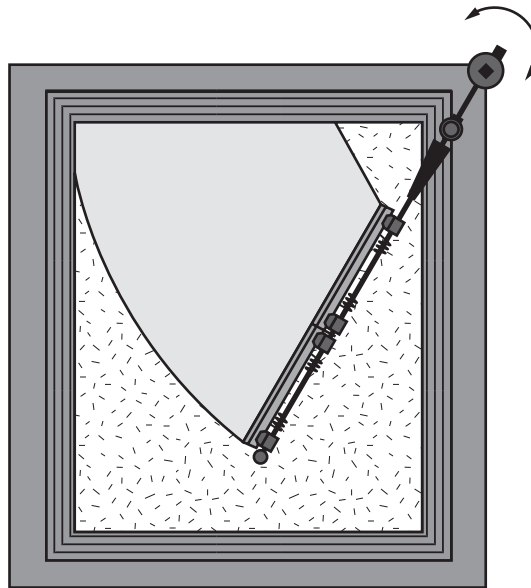


Figure 2.



**Recreation of Mary Anderson's illustration
for her window-cleaning device patent in 1903**

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Passage 2: Alabama Woman Stuck in NYC Traffic in 1902 Invented the Windshield Wiper

by Joe Palca

The following passage is a transcript from a radio interview with Mary Anderson's great-great-niece, Sara-Scott Wingo.

12 RACHEL MARTIN, HOST:

13 We're now going to take a moment to think about technology that we use without thinking. NPR's Joe Palca is exploring the origins of many common items, including the windshield wiper.

14 JOE PALCA, BYLINE: It may seem hard to imagine a world without windshield wipers, but there was. Mary Anderson lived in that world. In 1902, she was visiting New York City.

15 SARA-SCOTT WINGO: She was riding a streetcar, and it was snowing. And she observed that the streetcar driver had to get out and continually clean off the windshield.

16 PALCA: That's Sara-Scott Wingo.

17 WINGO: Mary Anderson was my great-great-aunt.

18 PALCA: So Anderson was riding in the streetcar in the snow. And she thought it didn't make sense that the driver had to keep jumping out to clean off the windshield. What if there were some sort of blade that could do it for him?

19 WINGO: She went home, drew a sketch . . .

20 PALCA: . . . And wrote up a description of her idea. Then she thought, what the heck, I'll apply for a patent.

21 [VOICE ACTRESS]: (Reading) Be it known to all that I, Mary Anderson, a citizen of the United States residing in Birmingham, in the county of Jefferson in the state of Alabama, have invented a new and useful improvement in window-cleaning devices.

22 PALCA: The patent application describes how the wiper was operated by a handle inside the vestibule of the motor car and was easily removable.

23 [VOICE ACTRESS]: (Reading) . . . Thus, leaving nothing to mar the usual appearance of the car during fair weather.

24 PALCA: The application was filed June 18, 1903. On November 10 that same year, the United States Patent Office awarded Anderson patent number 743801 for her new device. Sara-Scott Wingo says Anderson tried to interest manufacturing firms in making her

windshield wipers for the emerging motor car industry, but no takers. A letter from the firm of Dinning and Eckenstein is one of Wingo's prized possessions.

25 WINGO: (Reading) Dear madam, we beg to acknowledge receipt of your recent favor with reference to the sale of your patent. In reply, we regret to state we do not consider it to be of such commercial value as would warrant our undertaking its sale.

26 They missed out, don't you think?

27 PALCA: Sara-Scott Wingo doesn't know for sure why Anderson's invention never went anywhere. But she suspects it might have been because Anderson was such an independent woman.

28 WINGO: She didn't have a father. She didn't have a husband. And the world was kind of run by men back then.

29 PALCA: It doesn't seem as if Mary Anderson was crushed by the rejections. She lived another 50 years, long enough to see windshield wipers become ubiquitous.¹ Wingo says her family is proud of Anderson's accomplishments.

30 WINGO: I have three daughters. We talk about Mary Anderson a lot. And we all sort of feel like we want to be open and receptive to sort of our own Mary Anderson moments.

31 PALCA: If Anderson didn't get any money for her invention, at least she finally got some credit. In 2011, she was inducted into the Inventors Hall of Fame.

¹ ubiquitous: found everywhere

Excerpt from "Alabama Woman Stuck in NYC Traffic in 1902 Invented the Windshield Wiper" by Joe Palca. Copyright © 2017 by National Public Radio (NPR). Reprinted by permission of National Public Radio via Copyright Clearance Center.

1. Read these sentences from Passage 1.

“Mary put the patent in a drawer and, eventually, it expired. Several years later, someone else revived her idea, patented it, sold it, and made a very large sum of money.” (paragraph 11)

What is the meaning of the word revived as it is used in this sentence?

- Ⓐ lived out
- Ⓑ thought of
- Ⓒ brought back
- Ⓓ arranged again

2. Select the sentence that is illustrated by the image in Passage 1.
- Ⓐ "And simply because she felt sorry for the streetcar driver, who struggled to see through the glass." (paragraph 1)
 - Ⓑ "Once the glass became covered with rain or snow, the streetcar driver could fling open the middle for a clear view." (paragraph 2)
 - Ⓒ "She spent some time refining her drawings—making them more elaborate, adding more details." (paragraph 6)
 - Ⓓ "Once the invention was protected by patent, she wrote a large Canadian company offering to sell her rights." (paragraph 10)

- 3.** In Passage 1, what central idea is developed by describing Anderson's ride in a streetcar?
- Ⓐ Many important inventions have been created for the purpose of helping others.
 - Ⓑ Many people depended on professional drivers to get them to different places safely.
 - Ⓒ Anderson's curiosity about how to solve a common issue led to a major advancement.
 - Ⓓ Anderson's joy of traveling to new places influenced her to learn more about transportation.

4. In Passage 1, what do the quotations from the patent application in paragraphs 7 and 9 reveal about Anderson?
- Ⓐ She was knowledgeable and could explain her invention.
 - Ⓑ She was focused on changing the outer appearance of a car.
 - Ⓒ She improved both the interior and exterior functions of a car.
 - Ⓓ She thought that her invention was similar to previous solutions.

- 5.** In Passage 1, how does the author develop the argument that the windshield wiper “remains one of the greatest safety inventions of the modern-day automobile” (paragraph 11)?
- Ⓐ by emphasizing how much money it made for its time period
 - Ⓑ by contrasting the way it originally worked with its present functions
 - Ⓒ by describing how troublesome it was for people in the past to design
 - Ⓓ by comparing how it improved visibility for drivers in the past and present

- 6.** Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“When he opened the split glass, he was greeted with a burst of icy cold air and a blast of heavy, wet snow.” (paragraph 2)

How does this description emphasize the importance of Anderson’s invention?

- Ⓐ It shows that previous solutions were not good enough.
- Ⓑ It illustrates what it was like to ride a streetcar every day.
- Ⓒ It explains why engineers thought earlier ideas were successful.
- Ⓓ It reveals how streetcar drivers felt in different types of weather.

7. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What conclusion can be made based on the descriptions of Anderson's personal life in paragraphs 24–28 of Passage 2?

- Ⓐ Anderson gained recognition as a result of waiting patiently for the right timing.
- Ⓑ Anderson understood that her ideas were hard to accept since they were unproven.
- Ⓒ Anderson focused on being successful so that she would be remembered by strangers.
- Ⓓ Anderson received less recognition than she deserved because of the time period in which she lived.

Part B

Select a sentence from Passage 2 that supports the answer in Part A.

- Ⓐ "On November 10 that same year, the United States Patent Office awarded Anderson patent number 743801 for her new device." (paragraph 24)
- Ⓑ "Sara-Scott Wingo says Anderson tried to interest manufacturing firms in making her windshield wipers for the emerging motor car industry, but no takers." (paragraph 24)
- Ⓒ "In reply, we regret to state we do not consider it to be of such commercial value as would warrant our undertaking its sale." (paragraph 25)
- Ⓓ "She didn't have a father. She didn't have a husband. And the world was kind of run by men back then." (paragraph 28)

8. Read this paragraph from Passage 2.

29 PALCA: It doesn't seem as if Mary Anderson was crushed by the rejections. She lived another 50 years, long enough to see windshield wipers become ubiquitous. Wingo says her family is proud of Anderson's accomplishments.

What is the meaning of the word crushed as it is used in this paragraph?

- Ⓐ alarmed
- Ⓑ confused
- Ⓒ discouraged
- Ⓓ offended

- 9.** Select **two** ways Passage 2 develops the argument that Anderson deserved to be more widely known and supported during her lifetime.
- Ⓐ by describing how Anderson received a patent number from the “United States Patent Office” (paragraph 24)
 - Ⓑ by saying the manufacturing company “missed out” when it refused Anderson’s invention (paragraph 26)
 - Ⓒ by describing Anderson as an “independent woman” (paragraph 27)
 - Ⓓ by explaining that her current family members “talk about Mary Anderson a lot” (paragraph 30)
 - Ⓔ by explaining how Anderson “finally got some credit” when she was inducted into the Inventors Hall of Fame in 2011 (paragraph 31)

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10. Fill in the bubbles to show each author’s purpose for writing about Anderson in Passage 1, Passage 2, or both passages.

	Passage 1	Passage 2	Both Passages
to show how Anderson’s achievements affected her family	☐ Ⓐ	☐ Ⓑ	☐ Ⓒ
to describe how Anderson’s invention affected the world	☐ Ⓓ	☐ Ⓔ	☐ Ⓕ
to give the scientific reasoning for the design elements of Anderson’s invention	☐ Ⓖ	☐ Ⓕ	☐ Ⓖ

Passage 1:
from *To Sea: A Voyage of Discovery*

by Jeff Hendricks

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Passage 2: Villanelle

by W. E. Henley

This poem was published in 1887.

1 Where's the use of sighing?
Sorrow as you may,
Time is always flying—

Flying!—and defying
5 Men to say him nay . . .
Where's the use of sighing?

Look! To-day is dying
After yesterday.
Time is always flying.

10 Flying—and when crying
Cannot make him stay,
Where's the use of sighing?

Men with by-and-bying,
Fritter life away.
15 Time is always flying,

Flying!—O, from prying
Cease, and go to play.
Where's the use of sighing,
“Time is always flying?”

“Villanelle” by W. E. Henley, from *Ballades and Rondeaux, Chants Royal, Sestinas, Villanelles, &c.*, selected by Gleeson White. In the public domain.

11. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“This was the beginning of a routine.” (paragraph 10)

What is the meaning of the word routine as it is used in the passage?

- Ⓐ agreeing to a plan with others
- Ⓑ developing a secret friendship
- Ⓒ making a decision to learn more
- Ⓓ following a repeated set of actions

- 12.** How do the interactions between Juan and Ayva contribute to the development of Passage 1?
- Ⓐ They highlight the effects that music has on Juan and Ayva's relationship.
 - Ⓑ They demonstrate how nature helps Juan and Ayva get to know each other.
 - Ⓒ They allow Juan and Ayva to become friends despite having different backgrounds.
 - Ⓓ They reveal that Juan and Ayva can form a connection when they speak the same language.

13. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is a theme in Passage 1?

- Ⓐ Some friendships only last a short time.
- Ⓑ Generosity is given at unexpected times.
- Ⓒ Adventure provides hope for a better future.
- Ⓓ Holding on to regrets prevents success in life.

Part B

Which detail from Passage 1 helps develop the theme in Part A?

- Ⓐ Antonio's advice cheers up Juan.
- Ⓑ Juan is eager to sail with Antonio's crew.
- Ⓒ Ayva must offer Juan a gift equal to his flute.
- Ⓓ Juan must continue his journey without Ayva.

14. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“She thought it would be like magic to wander across the ocean in those magnificent ships.” (paragraph 21)

What does the phrase “like magic” suggest about Ayva?

- Ⓐ She thinks sailing is strange.
- Ⓑ She likes the idea of adventure.
- Ⓒ She dreams of changing someday.
- Ⓓ She believes the ships are imaginary.

15. Select **two** details from Passage 1 that show that Ayva is sad to see Juan go away.

- Ⓐ "When he finished, she turned to him and smiled broadly."
(paragraph 15)
- Ⓑ "The fleet would be leaving tomorrow." (paragraph 16)
- Ⓒ "'*Gracias*, Juan,' she said. 'I . . . will miss you . . . very much.'" (paragraph 20)
- Ⓓ "They were so unlike her people's small canoes, carved from tree trunks." (paragraph 21)
- Ⓔ "'Here is something to remember me by,' she said and placed the necklace around Juan's neck." (paragraph 23)

16. Select **two** sentences from Passage 1 that show how Juan and Ayva became friends.

- Ⓐ "Then he looked up and saw a young native girl." (paragraph 6)
- Ⓑ "She didn't speak Spanish, and he didn't speak her language." (paragraph 7)
- Ⓒ "When he finished, she clapped her hands and giggled." (paragraph 7)
- Ⓓ "And each time Juan would head back to his ship, she would give him a warm smile." (paragraph 11)
- Ⓔ "The girl brushed her dark hair from her face, bowed her head slightly, and returned his greeting." (paragraph 14)

17. What effect does the repetition of the line “Where’s the use of sighing” have on Passage 2?

- Ⓐ It creates a desire to travel and visit new places.
- Ⓑ It emphasizes that focusing on the past is pointless.
- Ⓒ It notes that people will come and go as they please.
- Ⓓ It reminds everyone to find amusement in their situations.

18. Read these lines from Passage 2.

“Men with by-and-bying,
Fritter life away.” (lines 13–14)

What does the author mean by the phrase “Fritter life away”?

- Ⓐ work toward goals
- Ⓑ eat and laugh merrily
- Ⓒ reflect on their wealth
- Ⓓ waste time and energy

19. In Passage 2, how does the author develop the theme that people should not regret the past?

- Ⓐ by sharing personal experiences
- Ⓑ by showing examples of a better life
- Ⓒ by asking if focusing on loss is helpful
- Ⓓ by explaining how relationships develop

20. In Passage 2, what point is the author making by repeating the phrase “Time is always flying”?

- Ⓐ People should enjoy opportunities in life.
- Ⓑ People should reflect more on their past.
- Ⓒ People should pursue adventure in their lives.
- Ⓓ People should focus on preparing for future challenges.

21. How does Passage 1 treat the idea of overcoming sad experiences differently than Passage 2 does?

- Ⓐ Passage 1 proves why it is important for people to mourn.
- Ⓑ Passage 1 shows how gifts allow people to hold on to memories.
- Ⓒ Passage 1 demonstrates that people’s feelings change over time.
- Ⓓ Passage 1 describes how a person’s attitude should be shaped by the past.

from *The Phantom Tollbooth*

by Norton Juster

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22. Read this sentence from the passage.

34 “That’s absurd,” objected Milo, whose head was spinning from all the numbers and questions.

How does the phrase “head was spinning” contribute to the meaning of the passage?

- Ⓐ It reveals that Milo thinks the Dodecahedron is funny.
- Ⓑ It expresses that Milo is confused by the math problems.
- Ⓒ It highlights that Milo is interested in discovering the truth.
- Ⓓ It implies that Milo thinks the Humbug needs help with math.

23. What are **two** ways that the imagery in paragraph 7 contributes to the meaning of the passage?

- Ⓐ It reveals how unusual the Dodecahedron looks.
- Ⓑ It implies that Milo helped build the Dodecahedron.
- Ⓒ It describes how the Dodecahedron teaches numbers.
- Ⓓ It suggests that Milo and the Dodecahedron are similar.
- Ⓔ It introduces how the Dodecahedron expresses himself.

24. Read this sentence from the passage.

“‘That may be true,’ he acknowledged, ‘but it’s completely accurate, and as long as the answer is right, who cares if the question is wrong?’”
(paragraph 35)

The word “accurate” comes from the Latin root *accuratus*, meaning “done with care.” Based on the root, what is the definition of the word accurate?

- Ⓐ balanced
- Ⓑ correct
- Ⓒ finished
- Ⓓ interesting

25. Which detail from the passage supports the theme that a person can learn to view the world differently through math?

- Ⓐ "As they argued, a most peculiar little figure stepped nimbly from behind the sign and approached them, talking all the while."
(paragraph 6)
- Ⓑ "'Is that bad?' asked Milo, making sure it was still there."
(paragraph 19)
- Ⓒ "'I never thought of it that way,' Milo admitted." (paragraph 23)
- Ⓓ "'I'm sure I don't know,' he replied, 'but if you did, you'd certainly know what to do with him.'"
(paragraph 33)

26. In paragraph 22, how does the Dodecahedron use a logical appeal?

- Ⓐ by describing why some shape names lead to frustration
- Ⓑ by suggesting how people ought to create their own names
- Ⓒ by suggesting why people should be named for their features
- Ⓓ by describing how authorities determine the names of objects

27. Read this sentence from the passage.

“Perhaps if you look at the picture you’ll know what I mean.”
(paragraph 7)

How does the switch to addressing the reader affect the passage?

- Ⓐ It hints at the Dodecahedron’s opinions of other characters.
- Ⓑ It demonstrates the narrator’s feelings toward the Dodecahedron.
- Ⓒ It highlights the narrator’s limit of words to describe the Dodecahedron.
- Ⓓ It suggests that the other characters struggle to understand the Dodecahedron.

28. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is revealed by the conversation between Milo, the Humbug, and Tock about the three different roads?

- Ⓐ The characters are tired from their long journey.
- Ⓑ The characters disagree about the right way to go.
- Ⓒ The characters are eager to meet new people in the city.
- Ⓓ The characters distrust the information presented on the sign.

Part B

How does the conversation in Part A affect the plot?

- Ⓐ It causes them to take a break.
- Ⓑ It causes them to take the shortest trip.
- Ⓒ It causes the Dodecahedron to talk to them.
- Ⓓ It causes the Dodecahedron to read the sign.

29. Which statement expresses a theme that is found in paragraphs 34–35 and 39–40?

- Ⓐ Difficult questions can lead to confusion.
- Ⓑ New people can make traveling impossible.
- Ⓒ Education is an easy way to make new friends.
- Ⓓ Choosing a path can be done without much thought.

Curious Kids: do cats and dogs understand us when we miaow¹ or bark?

by Quixi Sonntag

1 There's been a lot of research about communication between people and domestic animals like dogs and cats. But we don't yet have the answer to your very interesting question. We don't know what cats and dogs think or if they understand us when we use their noises.

2 As a veterinarian and animal behaviourist who studies different kinds of animals, my view is that we'd have to be very good at mimicking miaows and barks if we would really like to be understood by our pets. Our vocal cords are different to theirs, and they can hear that we make different sounds to what they do.

3 But we do know that dogs can definitely distinguish between different people's voices. They'll know when it's Mila who's talking, and when it's Alex. They're also sensitive to your tone of voice. They like high-pitched, friendly tones. And did you know that dogs can learn words?

4 Rico, a border collie, successfully learned more than 200 words representing different items. He could pick the correct item from all the items if asked to "fetch" whichever item. We do not think that he actually learnt the meaning of the words, but he was very good at associating different sounds with different objects.

5 When it comes to their own "voices," studies have shown that dogs and cats use different vocal signals to communicate different messages. A high-pitched, repetitive bark, for example, may mean your dog is anxious. A low-pitched bark may mean she's feeling aggressive. Cats also use certain sounds while hunting and others when relaxing.

6 But their "voices" are just one way in which dogs and cats communicate. They also use body language and tactile gestures—like coming to you for a pat, or nudging your hand with their nose when they want attention.

7 In the same way people also communicate using gestures and facial expressions. Research has shown that dogs are better than other species, like wolves, at interpreting our gestures and facial expressions.

¹miaow: an alternative spelling for the cat sound "meow"

Different communication forms

- 8 If you have dogs, you will have noticed that they're very sensitive to people's feelings and our ways of communicating. That's because they've evolved to live in close proximity with people.
- 9 Cats are not naturally social animals, but they also communicate with us and can be highly perceptive about what mood you're in and how you're feeling.
- 10 All of this is important when you think about the best ways to communicate with your dogs and cats. Since visual signals are really important to them, it's likely that they consider our body language, before listening to our sounds, so they can decide what it is that we're communicating.
- 11 Humans use language as our main means of communication. That's why we tend to want our pets to respond to our words. They certainly can learn to do this, as we have seen with Rico and thousands of other examples.
- 12 However, in many instances, they are actually responding to our body language cues and not the verbal cues we are using.
- 13 Take for example telling your dog to sit: most people say the word "sit," and at the same time point their finger at the dog. They think the dog sits because they are saying "sit"—but it's actually responding to the finger pointing. If you say the word "sit" without the hand gesture your dog will, in many cases, not sit. This proves how important body language is to dogs.
- 14 I would encourage everyone who owns pets, especially dogs, to learn more about their body language so that we can better interpret what they are trying to say to us. A common perception, for example, is that when a dog's tail is wagging it is always friendly. This is only true when the wag of the tail is wide and accompanied by a relaxed body. A dog whose tail is up in the air, with only the tip wagging, is actually saying "go away" and not "let's play."
- 15 The more time you spend learning your pets' body language and getting to know what different gestures mean, the more easily you'll be able to communicate with them—and you won't have to "miaow" or bark to do that.

"Curious Kids: do cats and dogs understand us when we miaow or bark?" by Quixi Sonntag, from theconversation.com. Licensed under the Creative Commons CC BY-ND 4.0 license.

30. Read this paragraph from the passage.

9 Cats are not naturally social animals, but they also communicate with us and can be highly perceptive about what mood you're in and how you're feeling.

The word "perceptive" comes from the Latin root *percipere*, meaning "obtain, gather," and the suffix *-ive*, meaning "tending to." Based on this information, what does perceptive mean as it is used in the passage?

- Ⓐ aware
- Ⓑ dependent
- Ⓒ nosy
- Ⓓ surprised

31. How does the section **Different communication forms** contribute to the passage?

- Ⓐ It provides examples of ways pets express themselves when near other animals.
- Ⓑ It challenges the idea that animals use their own language when communicating with each other.
- Ⓒ It warns pet owners to listen closely to the sounds their pets make when responding to their commands.
- Ⓓ It shifts the discussion from verbal exchanges to other ways people and pets can understand one another.

32. Ethos is an appeal used by writers to reveal their knowledge or credibility to the reader. Which detail from the passage uses an appeal to ethos?

- Ⓐ "As a veterinarian and animal behaviourist who studies different kinds of animals, my view is that we'd have to be very good at mimicking miaows and barks if we would really like to be understood by our pets." (paragraph 2)
- Ⓑ "But we do know that dogs can definitely distinguish between different people's voices. They'll know when it's Mila who's talking, and when it's Alex." (paragraph 3)
- Ⓒ "They certainly can learn to do this, as we have seen with Rico and thousands of other examples." (paragraph 11)
- Ⓓ "If you say the word 'sit' without the hand gesture your dog will, in many cases, not sit. This proves how important body language is to dogs." (paragraph 13)

33. Select a way that paragraphs 6 and 7 add to the development of ideas in the passage.

- Ⓐ They provide the opinions of those who disagree with the author.
- Ⓑ They include a story from the author's experience with her own pets.
- Ⓒ They introduce additional methods dogs and cats use to express messages to people.
- Ⓓ They explain people's preference for keeping dogs and cats as pets instead of other animals.

34. Which **two** details from the passage support the claim that imitating the sounds pets make is an ineffective way of communicating with them?

- Ⓐ "There's been a lot of research about communication between people and domestic animals . . ." (paragraph 1)
- Ⓑ "Our vocal cords are different to theirs, and they can hear that we make different sounds to what they do." (paragraph 2)
- Ⓒ "Cats also use certain sounds while hunting and others when relaxing." (paragraph 5)
- Ⓓ ". . . it's likely that they consider our body language, before listening to our sounds, so they can decide what it is that we're communicating." (paragraph 10)
- Ⓔ "That's why we tend to want our pets to respond to our words." (paragraph 11)

35. What kind of rhetorical appeal does the author make in paragraph 4?

- Ⓐ an appeal to credibility by mentioning Rico's breed
- Ⓑ an appeal to logic by explaining the extent of Rico's abilities
- Ⓒ an appeal to ethics by suggesting that Rico made fair choices
- Ⓓ an appeal to emotion by telling how Rico made his owners proud

- 36.** Complete the table by matching each detail to the central idea it supports.

	People often misinterpret interactions with animals.	Pets observe and react to people's behavior.	Both Central Ideas
"If you have dogs, you will have noticed that they're very sensitive to people's feelings and our ways of communicating." (paragraph 8)	(A)	(B)	(C)
"However, in many instances, they are actually responding to our body language cues and not the verbal cues we are using." (paragraph 12)	(D)	(E)	(F)
"A common perception, for example, is that when a dog's tail is wagging it is always friendly. This is only true when the wag of the tail is wide and accompanied by a relaxed body." (paragraph 14)	(G)	(H)	(I)



Grade 6 FAST ELA Reading

Test Release: 2024

Passage 1:

Mary Anderson: Windshield Wipers

by Catherine Thimmesh

- 1 It was a dreadful day, weatherwise. Snow and sleet pelted the pavement, and people burrowed deep within their coats. Hoping to catch the sights and escape the blustery cold, Mary Anderson of Birmingham, Alabama, climbed aboard a New York City streetcar. The year was 1902. It turned out to be a ride she would never forget, but not because of the scenery. Instead, the ride would inspire her to invent the very first windshield wiper. And simply because she felt sorry for the streetcar driver, who struggled to see through the glass. The invention would not only improve conditions for all drivers, but would save countless lives as well.
- 2 Earlier, top-notch engineers had tackled the problem of poor visibility in bad weather and came up with a solution. They split the windshield. Once the glass became covered with rain or snow, the streetcar driver could fling open the middle for a clear view. Trouble was, it didn't work. At least not very well. Mary watched helplessly as the driver desperately tried to see. When he opened the split glass, he was greeted with a burst of icy cold air and a blast of heavy, wet snow.
- 3 *"Why doesn't someone create a device to remove the snow?" Mary reportedly asked the people around her.*
- 4 *"It's been tried many times," they told her. "Can't be done."*
- 5 Nonsense, thought Mary, as she scribbled in her notebook. Why can't there be a lever on the inside that would move an arm on the outside to swipe off the snow? . . .
- 6 Later, when she returned to her home in Birmingham, she studied her sketches. She spent some time refining her drawings—making them more elaborate, adding more details. Satisfied at last, she brought her design to a small manufacturing company in Birmingham and hired them to make a model. Then, she filed a patent application.
- 7 *"My invention relates to an improvement in window-cleaning devices in which a radially-swinging arm is actuated by a handle from inside of a car-vestibule," Mary stated in her patent specification.*
- 8 In other words, a lever on the inside that would move an arm on the outside. Mary's wiper was made of wooden strips and pieces of rubber. She designed it to be removed in good weather so that it would not interfere with the appearance of the streetcar. One of her most important elements was the addition of a counterweight.

- 9 *This was used, she writes, “to provide means for maintaining a uniform pressure upon the glass throughout the entire area swept by my improved window-cleaning device.”*
- 10 In other words, it would swipe off the snow. Mary was awarded a patent in 1903 for a window-cleaning device—a windshield wiper. Once the invention was protected by patent, she wrote a large Canadian company offering to sell her rights. They weren’t interested. After reviewing her proposal, they decided that her invention had little, if any, commercial value. They simply didn’t think it would sell. They encouraged her, however, to submit any other “useful patents” she might have for their consideration.
- 11 Mary put the patent in a drawer and, eventually, it expired. Several years later, someone else revived her idea, patented it, sold it, and made a very large sum of money. Every day, lives are saved due to increased visibility during bad weather. Even in our high-tech society, the windshield wiper remains one of the greatest safety inventions of the modern-day automobile.

Figure 1.

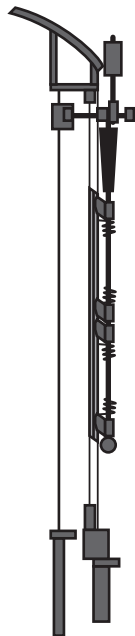
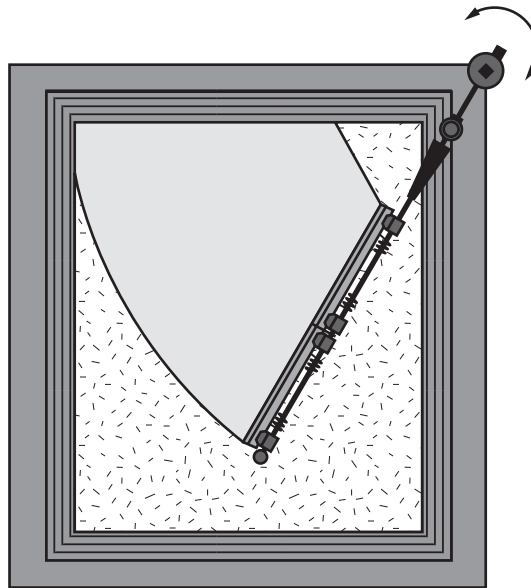


Figure 2.



**Recreation of Mary Anderson's illustration
for her window-cleaning device patent in 1903**

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Passage 2: Alabama Woman Stuck in NYC Traffic in 1902 Invented the Windshield Wiper

by Joe Palca

The following passage is a transcript from a radio interview with Mary Anderson's great-great-niece, Sara-Scott Wingo.

12 RACHEL MARTIN, HOST:

13 We're now going to take a moment to think about technology that we use without thinking. NPR's Joe Palca is exploring the origins of many common items, including the windshield wiper.

14 JOE PALCA, BYLINE: It may seem hard to imagine a world without windshield wipers, but there was. Mary Anderson lived in that world. In 1902, she was visiting New York City.

15 SARA-SCOTT WINGO: She was riding a streetcar, and it was snowing. And she observed that the streetcar driver had to get out and continually clean off the windshield.

16 PALCA: That's Sara-Scott Wingo.

17 WINGO: Mary Anderson was my great-great-aunt.

18 PALCA: So Anderson was riding in the streetcar in the snow. And she thought it didn't make sense that the driver had to keep jumping out to clean off the windshield. What if there were some sort of blade that could do it for him?

19 WINGO: She went home, drew a sketch . . .

20 PALCA: . . . And wrote up a description of her idea. Then she thought, what the heck, I'll apply for a patent.

21 [VOICE ACTRESS]: (Reading) Be it known to all that I, Mary Anderson, a citizen of the United States residing in Birmingham, in the county of Jefferson in the state of Alabama, have invented a new and useful improvement in window-cleaning devices.

22 PALCA: The patent application describes how the wiper was operated by a handle inside the vestibule of the motor car and was easily removable.

23 [VOICE ACTRESS]: (Reading) . . . Thus, leaving nothing to mar the usual appearance of the car during fair weather.

24 PALCA: The application was filed June 18, 1903. On November 10 that same year, the United States Patent Office awarded Anderson patent number 743801 for her new device. Sara-Scott Wingo says Anderson tried to interest manufacturing firms in making her

windshield wipers for the emerging motor car industry, but no takers. A letter from the firm of Dinning and Eckenstein is one of Wingo's prized possessions.

25 WINGO: (Reading) Dear madam, we beg to acknowledge receipt of your recent favor with reference to the sale of your patent. In reply, we regret to state we do not consider it to be of such commercial value as would warrant our undertaking its sale.

26 They missed out, don't you think?

27 PALCA: Sara-Scott Wingo doesn't know for sure why Anderson's invention never went anywhere. But she suspects it might have been because Anderson was such an independent woman.

28 WINGO: She didn't have a father. She didn't have a husband. And the world was kind of run by men back then.

29 PALCA: It doesn't seem as if Mary Anderson was crushed by the rejections. She lived another 50 years, long enough to see windshield wipers become ubiquitous.¹ Wingo says her family is proud of Anderson's accomplishments.

30 WINGO: I have three daughters. We talk about Mary Anderson a lot. And we all sort of feel like we want to be open and receptive to sort of our own Mary Anderson moments.

31 PALCA: If Anderson didn't get any money for her invention, at least she finally got some credit. In 2011, she was inducted into the Inventors Hall of Fame.

¹ ubiquitous: found everywhere

Excerpt from "Alabama Woman Stuck in NYC Traffic in 1902 Invented the Windshield Wiper" by Joe Palca. Copyright © 2017 by National Public Radio (NPR). Reprinted by permission of National Public Radio via Copyright Clearance Center.

1. Read these sentences from Passage 1.

“Mary put the patent in a drawer and, eventually, it expired. Several years later, someone else revived her idea, patented it, sold it, and made a very large sum of money.” (paragraph 11)

What is the meaning of the word revived as it is used in this sentence?

- Ⓐ lived out
- Ⓑ thought of
- Ⓒ brought back
- Ⓓ arranged again

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 81%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of Greek and Latin roots and affixes to determine meanings of words and phrases in grade-level content.

2. Select the sentence that is illustrated by the image in Passage 1.
- Ⓐ “And simply because she felt sorry for the streetcar driver, who struggled to see through the glass.” (paragraph 1)
 - Ⓑ “Once the glass became covered with rain or snow, the streetcar driver could fling open the middle for a clear view.” (paragraph 2)
 - Ⓒ “She spent some time refining her drawings—making them more elaborate, adding more details.” (paragraph 6)
 - Ⓓ “Once the invention was protected by patent, she wrote a large Canadian company offering to sell her rights.” (paragraph 10)

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 38%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how individual text sections and/or features convey meaning in texts.

3. In Passage 1, what central idea is developed by describing Anderson's ride in a streetcar?
- Ⓐ Many important inventions have been created for the purpose of helping others.
 - Ⓑ Many people depended on professional drivers to get them to different places safely.
 - Ⓒ Anderson's curiosity about how to solve a common issue led to a major advancement.
 - Ⓓ Anderson's joy of traveling to new places influenced her to learn more about transportation.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 51%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the central idea(s), implied or explicit, and its development throughout a text.

4. In Passage 1, what do the quotations from the patent application in paragraphs 7 and 9 reveal about Anderson?
- Ⓐ She was knowledgeable and could explain her invention.
 - Ⓑ She was focused on changing the outer appearance of a car.
 - Ⓒ She improved both the interior and exterior functions of a car.
 - Ⓓ She thought that her invention was similar to previous solutions.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 63%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how individual text sections and/or features convey meaning in texts.

5. In Passage 1, how does the author develop the argument that the windshield wiper “remains one of the greatest safety inventions of the modern-day automobile” (paragraph 11)?
- Ⓐ by emphasizing how much money it made for its time period
 - Ⓑ by contrasting the way it originally worked with its present functions
 - Ⓒ by describing how troublesome it was for people in the past to design
 - Ⓓ by comparing how it improved visibility for drivers in the past and present

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 65%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Track the development of an argument, identifying the types of reasoning used.

6. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“When he opened the split glass, he was greeted with a burst of icy cold air and a blast of heavy, wet snow.” (paragraph 2)

How does this description emphasize the importance of Anderson’s invention?

- Ⓐ It shows that previous solutions were not good enough.
- Ⓑ It illustrates what it was like to ride a streetcar every day.
- Ⓒ It explains why engineers thought earlier ideas were successful.
- Ⓓ It reveals how streetcar drivers felt in different types of weather.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 52%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how figurative language contributes to tone and meaning in text(s).

7. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What conclusion can be made based on the descriptions of Anderson's personal life in paragraphs 24–28 of Passage 2?

- Ⓐ Anderson gained recognition as a result of waiting patiently for the right timing.
- Ⓑ Anderson understood that her ideas were hard to accept since they were unproven.
- Ⓒ Anderson focused on being successful so that she would be remembered by strangers.
- Ⓓ Anderson received less recognition than she deserved because of the time period in which she lived.

Part B

Select a sentence from Passage 2 that supports the answer in Part A.

- Ⓐ "On November 10 that same year, the United States Patent Office awarded Anderson patent number 743801 for her new device." (paragraph 24)
- Ⓑ "Sara-Scott Wingo says Anderson tried to interest manufacturing firms in making her windshield wipers for the emerging motor car industry, but no takers." (paragraph 24)
- Ⓒ "In reply, we regret to state we do not consider it to be of such commercial value as would warrant our undertaking its sale." (paragraph 25)
- Ⓓ "She didn't have a father. She didn't have a husband. And the world was kind of run by men back then." (paragraph 28)

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Answer Key: Part A: Option D and Part B: Option D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 34%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Track the development of an argument, identifying the types of reasoning used.

8. Read this paragraph from Passage 2.

29 PALCA: It doesn't seem as if Mary Anderson was crushed by the rejections. She lived another 50 years, long enough to see windshield wipers become ubiquitous. Wingo says her family is proud of Anderson's accomplishments.

What is the meaning of the word crushed as it is used in this paragraph?

- Ⓐ alarmed
- Ⓑ confused
- Ⓒ discouraged
- Ⓓ offended

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 71%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the connotative and denotative meaning of words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

Florida Test Release Support Document

9. Select **two** ways Passage 2 develops the argument that Anderson deserved to be more widely known and supported during her lifetime.
- Ⓐ by describing how Anderson received a patent number from the “United States Patent Office” (paragraph 24)
 - Ⓑ by saying the manufacturing company “missed out” when it refused Anderson’s invention (paragraph 26)
 - Ⓒ by describing Anderson as an “independent woman” (paragraph 27)
 - Ⓓ by explaining that her current family members “talk about Mary Anderson a lot” (paragraph 30)
 - Ⓔ by explaining how Anderson “finally got some credit” when she was inducted into the Inventors Hall of Fame in 2011 (paragraph 31)

Answer Key: B, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 37%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Track the development of an argument, identifying the types of reasoning used.

- 10.** Fill in the bubbles to show each author’s purpose for writing about Anderson in Passage 1, Passage 2, or both passages.

	Passage 1	Passage 2	Both Passages
to show how Anderson’s achievements affected her family	☐ A	☒ B	☐ C
to describe how Anderson’s invention affected the world	☐ D	☐ E	☒ F
to give the scientific reasoning for the design elements of Anderson’s invention	☒ G	☐ H	☐ I

Answer Key: B, F, G

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 49%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Analyze authors’ purpose(s) in multiple accounts of the same event or topic.

Passage 1: **from *To Sea: A Voyage of Discovery***

by Jeff Hendricks

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Passage 2: Villanelle

by W. E. Henley

This poem was published in 1887.

1 Where's the use of sighing?
Sorrow as you may,
Time is always flying—

Flying!—and defying
5 Men to say him nay . . .
Where's the use of sighing?

Look! To-day is dying
After yesterday.
Time is always flying.

10 Flying—and when crying
Cannot make him stay,
Where's the use of sighing?

Men with by-and-bying,
Fritter life away.
15 Time is always flying,

Flying!—O, from prying
Cease, and go to play.
Where's the use of sighing,
“Time is always flying?”

*“Villanelle” by W. E. Henley, from *Ballades and Rondeaux, Chants Royal, Sestinas, Villanelles, &c.*, selected by Gleeson White. In the public domain.*

11. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“This was the beginning of a routine.” (paragraph 10)

What is the meaning of the word routine as it is used in the passage?

- Ⓐ agreeing to a plan with others
- Ⓑ developing a secret friendship
- Ⓒ making a decision to learn more
- Ⓓ following a repeated set of actions

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 83%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the connotative and denotative meaning of words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

12. How do the interactions between Juan and Ayva contribute to the development of Passage 1?

- Ⓐ They highlight the effects that music has on Juan and Ayva's relationship.
- Ⓑ They demonstrate how nature helps Juan and Ayva get to know each other.
- Ⓒ They allow Juan and Ayva to become friends despite having different backgrounds.
- Ⓓ They reveal that Juan and Ayva can form a connection when they speak the same language.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 57%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how the interaction between characters contributes to the development of a plot in a literary text.

13. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is a theme in Passage 1?

- ☒ Ⓐ Some friendships only last a short time.
- ☐ Ⓑ Generosity is given at unexpected times.
- ☐ Ⓒ Adventure provides hope for a better future.
- ☐ Ⓓ Holding on to regrets prevents success in life.

Part B

Which detail from Passage 1 helps develop the theme in Part A?

- ☐ Ⓐ Antonio's advice cheers up Juan.
- ☐ Ⓑ Juan is eager to sail with Antonio's crew.
- ☐ Ⓒ Ayva must offer Juan a gift equal to his flute.
- ☒ Ⓓ Juan must continue his journey without Ayva.

Answer Key: Part A: A and Part B: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 46%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the development of stated or implied theme(s) throughout a literary text.

14. Read this sentence from Passage 1.

“She thought it would be like magic to wander across the ocean in those magnificent ships.” (paragraph 21)

What does the phrase “like magic” suggest about Ayva?

- Ⓐ She thinks sailing is strange.
- Ⓑ She likes the idea of adventure.
- Ⓒ She dreams of changing someday.
- Ⓓ She believes the ships are imaginary.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 63%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how figurative language contributes to tone and meaning in text(s).

15. Select **two** details from Passage 1 that show that Ayva is sad to see Juan go away.

- Ⓐ "When he finished, she turned to him and smiled broadly." (paragraph 15)
- Ⓑ "The fleet would be leaving tomorrow." (paragraph 16)
- Ⓒ "'*Gracias*, Juan,' she said. 'I . . . will miss you . . . very much.'" (paragraph 20)
- Ⓓ "They were so unlike her people's small canoes, carved from tree trunks." (paragraph 21)
- Ⓔ "'Here is something to remember me by,' she said and placed the necklace around Juan's neck." (paragraph 23)

Answer Key: C, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 76%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how the interaction between characters contributes to the development of a plot in a literary text.

16. Select **two** sentences from Passage 1 that show how Juan and Ayva became friends.

- Ⓐ "Then he looked up and saw a young native girl." (paragraph 6)
- Ⓑ "She didn't speak Spanish, and he didn't speak her language." (paragraph 7)
- Ⓒ "When he finished, she clapped her hands and giggled." (paragraph 7)
- Ⓓ "And each time Juan would head back to his ship, she would give him a warm smile." (paragraph 11)
- Ⓔ "The girl brushed her dark hair from her face, bowed her head slightly, and returned his greeting." (paragraph 14)

Answer Key: C, D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 35%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how the interaction between characters contributes to the development of a plot in a literary text.

17. What effect does the repetition of the line “Where’s the use of sighing” have on Passage 2?

- Ⓐ It creates a desire to travel and visit new places.
- Ⓑ It emphasizes that focusing on the past is pointless.
- Ⓒ It notes that people will come and go as they please.
- Ⓓ It reminds everyone to find amusement in their situations.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 58%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.4

Benchmark Description: Describe the impact of various poetic forms on meaning and style.

18. Read these lines from Passage 2.

“Men with by-and-bying,
Fritter life away.” (lines 13–14)

What does the author mean by the phrase “Fritter life away”?

- Ⓐ work toward goals
- Ⓑ eat and laugh merrily
- Ⓒ reflect on their wealth
- Ⓓ waste time and energy

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 59%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the connotative and denotative meaning of words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

19. In Passage 2, how does the author develop the theme that people should not regret the past?

- Ⓐ by sharing personal experiences
- Ⓑ by showing examples of a better life
- Ⓒ by asking if focusing on loss is helpful
- Ⓓ by explaining how relationships develop

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 35%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the development of stated or implied theme(s) throughout a literary text.

20. In Passage 2, what point is the author making by repeating the phrase “Time is always flying”?

- ☒ Ⓐ People should enjoy opportunities in life.
- ☐ Ⓑ People should reflect more on their past.
- ☐ Ⓒ People should pursue adventure in their lives.
- ☐ Ⓓ People should focus on preparing for future challenges.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 64%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.4

Benchmark Description: Describe the impact of various poetic forms on meaning and style.

21. How does Passage 1 treat the idea of overcoming sad experiences differently than Passage 2 does?

- Ⓐ Passage 1 proves why it is important for people to mourn.
- Ⓑ Passage 1 shows how gifts allow people to hold on to memories.
- Ⓒ Passage 1 demonstrates that people’s feelings change over time.
- Ⓓ Passage 1 describes how a person’s attitude should be shaped by the past.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 57%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Compare and contrast how authors from different time periods address the same or related topics.

from *The Phantom Tollbooth*

by Norton Juster

Permissions were not secured for the use of this passage on a public website. For your reference, the citation for the passage and for items 22, 24, 25, and 27 is as follows: Norton Juster, *The Phantom Tollbooth* (New York: Alfred A. Knopf, Inc., 1989), 171-176.

22. Read this sentence from the passage.

34 “That’s absurd,” objected Milo, whose head was spinning from all the numbers and questions.

How does the phrase “head was spinning” contribute to the meaning of the passage?

- Ⓐ It reveals that Milo thinks the Dodecahedron is funny.
- Ⓑ It expresses that Milo is confused by the math problems.
- Ⓒ It highlights that Milo is interested in discovering the truth.
- Ⓓ It implies that Milo thinks the Humbug needs help with math.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 78%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how figurative language contributes to tone and meaning in text(s).

23. What are **two** ways that the imagery in paragraph 7 contributes to the meaning of the passage?

- Ⓐ It reveals how unusual the Dodecahedron looks.
- Ⓑ It implies that Milo helped build the Dodecahedron.
- Ⓒ It describes how the Dodecahedron teaches numbers.
- Ⓓ It suggests that Milo and the Dodecahedron are similar.
- Ⓔ It introduces how the Dodecahedron expresses himself.

Answer Key: A, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 52%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how figurative language contributes to tone and meaning in text(s).

24. Read this sentence from the passage.

“‘That may be true,’ he acknowledged, ‘but it’s completely accurate, and as long as the answer is right, who cares if the question is wrong?’”
(paragraph 35)

The word “accurate” comes from the Latin root *accuratus*, meaning “done with care.” Based on the root, what is the definition of the word accurate?

- Ⓐ balanced
- Ⓑ correct
- Ⓒ finished
- Ⓓ interesting

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 74%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of Greek and Latin roots and affixes to determine meanings of words and phrases in grade-level content.

25. Which detail from the passage supports the theme that a person can learn to view the world differently through math?

- Ⓐ "As they argued, a most peculiar little figure stepped nimbly from behind the sign and approached them, talking all the while." (paragraph 6)
- Ⓑ "'Is that bad?' asked Milo, making sure it was still there." (paragraph 19)
- Ⓒ "'I never thought of it that way,' Milo admitted." (paragraph 23)
- Ⓓ "'I'm sure I don't know,' he replied, 'but if you did, you'd certainly know what to do with him.'" (paragraph 33)

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 49%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the development of stated or implied theme(s) throughout a literary text.

26. In paragraph 22, how does the Dodecahedron use a logical appeal?

- Ⓐ by describing why some shape names lead to frustration
- Ⓑ by suggesting how people ought to create their own names
- Ⓒ by suggesting why people should be named for their features
- Ⓓ by describing how authorities determine the names of objects

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 37%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.3.4

Benchmark Description: Identify rhetorical appeals in a text.

27. Read this sentence from the passage.

“Perhaps if you look at the picture you’ll know what I mean.”
(paragraph 7)

How does the switch to addressing the reader affect the passage?

- Ⓐ It hints at the Dodecahedron’s opinions of other characters.
- Ⓑ It demonstrates the narrator’s feelings toward the Dodecahedron.
- Ⓒ It highlights the narrator’s limit of words to describe the Dodecahedron.
- Ⓓ It suggests that the other characters struggle to understand the Dodecahedron.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 38%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.3

Benchmark Description: Explain the influence of multiple narrators and/or shifts in point of view in a literary text.

28. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is revealed by the conversation between Milo, the Humbug, and Tock about the three different roads?

- Ⓐ The characters are tired from their long journey.
- Ⓑ The characters disagree about the right way to go.
- Ⓒ The characters are eager to meet new people in the city.
- Ⓓ The characters distrust the information presented on the sign.

Part B

How does the conversation in Part A affect the plot?

- Ⓐ It causes them to take a break.
- Ⓑ It causes them to take the shortest trip.
- Ⓒ It causes the Dodecahedron to talk to them.
- Ⓓ It causes the Dodecahedron to read the sign.

Answer Key: Part A: B and Part B: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 43%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Analyze how the interaction between characters contributes to the development of a plot in a literary text.

29. Which statement expresses a theme that is found in paragraphs 34–35 and 39–40?

- Ⓐ Difficult questions can lead to confusion.
- Ⓑ New people can make traveling impossible.
- Ⓒ Education is an easy way to make new friends.
- Ⓓ Choosing a path can be done without much thought.

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 55%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the development of stated or implied theme(s) throughout a literary text.

Curious Kids: do cats and dogs understand us when we miaow¹ or bark?

by Quixi Sonntag

- 1 There's been a lot of research about communication between people and domestic animals like dogs and cats. But we don't yet have the answer to your very interesting question. We don't know what cats and dogs think or if they understand us when we use their noises.
- 2 As a veterinarian and animal behaviourist who studies different kinds of animals, my view is that we'd have to be very good at mimicking miaows and barks if we would really like to be understood by our pets. Our vocal cords are different to theirs, and they can hear that we make different sounds to what they do.
- 3 But we do know that dogs can definitely distinguish between different people's voices. They'll know when it's Mila who's talking, and when it's Alex. They're also sensitive to your tone of voice. They like high-pitched, friendly tones. And did you know that dogs can learn words?
- 4 Rico, a border collie, successfully learned more than 200 words representing different items. He could pick the correct item from all the items if asked to "fetch" whichever item. We do not think that he actually learnt the meaning of the words, but he was very good at associating different sounds with different objects.
- 5 When it comes to their own "voices," studies have shown that dogs and cats use different vocal signals to communicate different messages. A high-pitched, repetitive bark, for example, may mean your dog is anxious. A low-pitched bark may mean she's feeling aggressive. Cats also use certain sounds while hunting and others when relaxing.
- 6 But their "voices" are just one way in which dogs and cats communicate. They also use body language and tactile gestures—like coming to you for a pat, or nudging your hand with their nose when they want attention.
- 7 In the same way people also communicate using gestures and facial expressions. Research has shown that dogs are better than other species, like wolves, at interpreting our gestures and facial expressions.

¹miaow: an alternative spelling for the cat sound "meow"

Different communication forms

- 8 If you have dogs, you will have noticed that they're very sensitive to people's feelings and our ways of communicating. That's because they've evolved to live in close proximity with people.
- 9 Cats are not naturally social animals, but they also communicate with us and can be highly perceptive about what mood you're in and how you're feeling.
- 10 All of this is important when you think about the best ways to communicate with your dogs and cats. Since visual signals are really important to them, it's likely that they consider our body language, before listening to our sounds, so they can decide what it is that we're communicating.
- 11 Humans use language as our main means of communication. That's why we tend to want our pets to respond to our words. They certainly can learn to do this, as we have seen with Rico and thousands of other examples.
- 12 However, in many instances, they are actually responding to our body language cues and not the verbal cues we are using.
- 13 Take for example telling your dog to sit: most people say the word "sit," and at the same time point their finger at the dog. They think the dog sits because they are saying "sit"—but it's actually responding to the finger pointing. If you say the word "sit" without the hand gesture your dog will, in many cases, not sit. This proves how important body language is to dogs.
- 14 I would encourage everyone who owns pets, especially dogs, to learn more about their body language so that we can better interpret what they are trying to say to us. A common perception, for example, is that when a dog's tail is wagging it is always friendly. This is only true when the wag of the tail is wide and accompanied by a relaxed body. A dog whose tail is up in the air, with only the tip wagging, is actually saying "go away" and not "let's play."
- 15 The more time you spend learning your pets' body language and getting to know what different gestures mean, the more easily you'll be able to communicate with them—and you won't have to "miaow" or bark to do that.

"Curious Kids: do cats and dogs understand us when we miaow or bark?" by Quixi Sonntag, from theconversation.com. Licensed under the Creative Commons CC BY-ND 4.0 license.

30. Read this paragraph from the passage.

9 Cats are not naturally social animals, but they also communicate with us and can be highly perceptive about what mood you're in and how you're feeling.

The word "perceptive" comes from the Latin root *percipere*, meaning "obtain, gather," and the suffix *-ive*, meaning "tending to." Based on this information, what does perceptive mean as it is used in the passage?

- ☒ (A) aware
- ☐ (B) dependent
- ☐ (C) nosy
- ☐ (D) surprised

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 78%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of Greek and Latin roots and affixes to determine meanings of words and phrases in grade-level content.

31. How does the section **Different communication forms** contribute to the passage?

- Ⓐ It provides examples of ways pets express themselves when near other animals.
- Ⓑ It challenges the idea that animals use their own language when communicating with each other.
- Ⓒ It warns pet owners to listen closely to the sounds their pets make when responding to their commands.
- Ⓓ It shifts the discussion from verbal exchanges to other ways people and pets can understand one another.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 44%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how individual text sections and/or features convey meaning in texts.

32. Ethos is an appeal used by writers to reveal their knowledge or credibility to the reader. Which detail from the passage uses an appeal to ethos?

- Ⓐ "As a veterinarian and animal behaviourist who studies different kinds of animals, my view is that we'd have to be very good at mimicking miaows and barks if we would really like to be understood by our pets." (paragraph 2)
- Ⓑ "But we do know that dogs can definitely distinguish between different people's voices. They'll know when it's Mila who's talking, and when it's Alex." (paragraph 3)
- Ⓒ "They certainly can learn to do this, as we have seen with Rico and thousands of other examples." (paragraph 11)
- Ⓓ "If you say the word 'sit' without the hand gesture your dog will, in many cases, not sit. This proves how important body language is to dogs." (paragraph 13)

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 62%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.3.4

Benchmark Description: Identify rhetorical appeals in a text.

33. Select a way that paragraphs 6 and 7 add to the development of ideas in the passage.

- Ⓐ They provide the opinions of those who disagree with the author.
- Ⓑ They include a story from the author’s experience with her own pets.
- Ⓒ They introduce additional methods dogs and cats use to express messages to people.
- Ⓓ They explain people’s preference for keeping dogs and cats as pets instead of other animals.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 79%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how individual text sections and/or features convey meaning in texts.

34. Which **two** details from the passage support the claim that imitating the sounds pets make is an ineffective way of communicating with them?

- Ⓐ "There's been a lot of research about communication between people and domestic animals . . ." (paragraph 1)
- Ⓑ "Our vocal cords are different to theirs, and they can hear that we make different sounds to what they do." (paragraph 2)
- Ⓒ "Cats also use certain sounds while hunting and others when relaxing." (paragraph 5)
- Ⓓ ". . . it's likely that they consider our body language, before listening to our sounds, so they can decide what it is that we're communicating." (paragraph 10)
- Ⓔ "That's why we tend to want our pets to respond to our words." (paragraph 11)

Answer Key: B, D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 54%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Track the development of an argument, identifying the types of reasoning used.

35. What kind of rhetorical appeal does the author make in paragraph 4?

- Ⓐ an appeal to credibility by mentioning Rico’s breed
- Ⓑ an appeal to logic by explaining the extent of Rico’s abilities
- Ⓒ an appeal to ethics by suggesting that Rico made fair choices
- Ⓓ an appeal to emotion by telling how Rico made his owners proud

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 70%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.3.4

Benchmark Description: Identify rhetorical appeals in a text.

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- 36.** Complete the table by matching each detail to the central idea it supports.

	People often misinterpret interactions with animals.	Pets observe and react to people's behavior.	Both Central Ideas
"If you have dogs, you will have noticed that they're very sensitive to people's feelings and our ways of communicating." (paragraph 8)	(A)	(B)	(C)
"However, in many instances, they are actually responding to our body language cues and not the verbal cues we are using." (paragraph 12)	(D)	(E)	(F)
"A common perception, for example, is that when a dog's tail is wagging it is always friendly. This is only true when the wag of the tail is wide and accompanied by a relaxed body." (paragraph 14)	(G)	(H)	(I)

Answer Key: B, F, G

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 27%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.6.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Analyze the central idea(s), implied or explicit, and its development throughout a text.